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Team spirit can make anything happen and the Jharkhand team is living proof. They have achieved their dreams by working as a unit.

B.N. PRASAD, V-P, Jharkhand Women's Hockey Association

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poor families, to play without worrying about money. Seven out of 16 tribal girls finally played for the country.

The Bihar Women's Hockey Association was established in 1984. Its name changed after the creation of Jharkhand, but over the last two decades, more than 50 of their girls have made it to the national hockey team. Besides, more than 100 women hockey players from the state have got placed in government jobs.

But beyond the statistics, Prasad

has changed the lives of many women in the state. "It's neither altruism nor love for the tribals alone that made me do it. I just love the sport," he says. The reward for his efforts comes from the girls itself. In a women's hockey tournament held in Mumbai, Prasad's team lost to the Railway's team because of a goal scored by Mamta Tigga—a tribal girl who had left Jharkhand after the Railways offered her a job. After the match, she came to touch his feet.

Seven years after his retirement, Prasad has many worries. For one, his son, Ashok Kumar, 37, is yet to find a permanent job and as a corporation employee, Prasad also has no pension. Surprisingly then, as senior vice-president of the Jharkhand Women's Hockey Association, he is eager to pass on the baton, but there are no takers. All his worries cease only when he is on the field. For then, it's all about the game.